

YDZ ENGLISH

TERM 2

WEEK 9

SIMPLE PAST CONTINUOUS

We use the Past Continuous...

1. ... to talk about actions or situations that lasted for some time in the past, and whose duration time is unknown or unimportant.
 - I was watching my favourite TV show.
 - The woman was crying.
 - Her car was purring.
2. ... when one action in progress is interrupted by another action in the past. We usually use **when or while** to link these two sentences.
 - I was waiting for Henna when the bus arrived.
 - While Terry was studying, the postman came with her new books.
 - While Rachel was singing, her family taped her performance.
3. ... to talk about two or more activities happening at the same. We usually use **while** to link the two sentences.
 - I was watching TV while Joey was talking to you on the phone.
 - While Ross was washing his car, Ted was vacuuming the house.

To form a sentence in the Past Continuous, you need:

1. The proper conjugation of the **auxiliary verb "to be"** in the past form (was / were)
2. And verb + **ing**

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
I was having lunch with my friends when I heard the news.	I wasn't watching TV when I heard the news.	Were you watching TV when you heard the news?
You were having a bath when Danny called.	You weren't having a bath when Danny called.	Were you having a bath when Danny called?

Monica was planning her wedding when her boyfriend left her.	Monica wasn't planning her wedding when her boyfriend left her.	Was Monica planning her wedding when her boyfriend left her?
We were dancing when the electricity went off.	We weren't dancing when the electricity went off.	Were we dancing when the electricity went off?

EXERCISES

A. Make affirmative, negative or questions

1) (he / cook)

2) (she / play cards)?

3) (I / not / cry)

4) (you / not / feel well)

5) (where / you / go when I met you)?

6) (she / not / sleeping at midnight)

7) (You / work / when / I / call)?

8) (you / sleep when I got home)?

9) (it / rain at lunchtime)

10) (what / you / do /yesterday?)

11) (why / she / run)?

12) (you / not / sleep/ when / I / phone)

13)(what / they / do at that time)?

14) (he / not / watch a film at 3pm)

15) (I / do my homework at eight o'clock)

16) (where / it / rain)?

17) (you / shop when I called you / ?)

18) (she / eat dinner when we arrived)

19) (he / live in Tokyo at the time)?

20) (it / snow)?

B. Fill in the blanks with WHEN or WHILE

1. _____ my father was reading a book , my mother was looking at the family album.
2. I was having a shower , _____ my friend broke my mother's favourite vase.
3. _____ the teacher came into the classroom ,some students were arguing with each other.
4. I arrived home , _____ all the guests were having tea and biscuits.
5. _____ she was a little girl , she visited her relatives with her mother.
6. I liked working in group and pairs , _____ I was a secondary school student.
7. _____ Sue was waiting for the 12 o'clock train , she met an old friend.
8. The Pearsons were having a large breakfast , _____ the doorbell rang.
9. My father was waiting in the car , _____ my mother was doing shopping.
10. What were you doing _____ the teacher looked at you suddenly.
11. _____ the train left , Thomas was rushing to the station.
12. The electricity went off , _____ we were watching a horror film.
13. _____ Mathew was going to the library , he saw a car accident on Mapple Street.
14. The baby boy started crying , _____ his mother was combing his hair.
15. _____ the mother was doing the washing up , the twins were sweeping the floor.
16. The sun was rising , _____ we reached the summit of the mountain.
17. _____ Susan entered the living room , everybody began singing 'Happy Birthday'.
18. Mr.Robinson fell off the tree _____ he was looking at the little bird's nest.